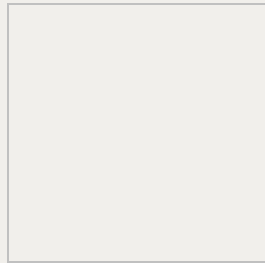


IN PROFILE

Vaslav Nijinsky

The greatest choreographer and dancer of his age, Nijinsky was born in Kiev to Polish parents. From the age of nine, he trained at the Imperial Ballet School in St. Petersburg and in 1909 joined Sergei Diaghilev's Ballets Russes. The famous dance company took Paris by storm, shocking audiences with its daring productions. Nijinsky's interpretation of Debussy's *L'Après-midi d'un faune* was hugely controversial. Clad in a tight body-suit designed to resemble an animal's skin (the mythical faun was half-man, half-goat), he accentuated the sensual content of the music in a graphic manner.



LEON BAKST'S DESIGN FOR NIJINSKY IN *L'APRÈS-MIDI D'UN FAUNE*,
1912